

Fedora 19 released

The second major release of the Fedora Linux project, Fedora 19, has been released. The Red Hat-sponsored project has been released seven months after the Fedora Linux 18 and offers several new features for server administrators.

The latest version first made its appearance in the end of May, giving a sneak peek into the world of Fedora 19. The features list is an impressive one with new Federated VoIP, high-availability features, advanced firewall security and the latest PHP 5.5 stack.

Now that Fedora 19 has been released, developers will now focus on the development of Fedora 20, said Robyn Bergeron, Fedora project leader.



Linux Mint 15 Xfce released

Linux has often been touted as the choice for anyone who doesn't like Microsoft's user interface and, more importantly, doesn't like paying the company for every subscription. Linux Mint is one popular OS, which offers a 'standard' distribution with the Cinnamon or MATE desktop.

The latest to hit the market is the Linux Mint Xfce desktop distribution, after what appears to be a long delay. This delay was earlier attributed partly to the fact that although it has been derived from Ubuntu, the desktops weren't actually derived from the Xubuntu (Xfce) or Kubuntu (KDE) distributions. But, in fact, they were created by the developers at Linux Mint, based on the latest Mint release.

However, the live/installer image does not seem to be UEFI-boot compatible, and the user will have to enable legacy boot support to get the live USB image to work. The Linux Mint 15 Xfce desktop is based on Xfce version 4.10, and works well with Graeme Gott's Whisker Menu application launcher.



Linus Torvalds brings out Linux Kernel 3.11 RC1

Linus Torvalds has just brought out the first release candidate in the 3.11 branch of the Linux kernel, which is immediately available for download.

The latest branch of the Linux kernel 3.11 has arrived pretty soon and, as Linus Torvalds has pointed out, this is actually a very small update compared to the corresponding 3.10 release, and a lot of changes and improvements have been pushed into the next version of the Linux kernel. Linus Torvalds mentioned in his official announcement, "This merge window was smaller in terms of the number of commits, than the 3.10 merge window, but we actually have more new lines."

"Most of that seems to be in staging—a full third of all changes by line-count is staging—and merging in Lustre is the bulk of that. Let's see how that all turns out; I have to say that we don't have a great track record on merging filesystems through staging," he added.

Aakash 4 to run on Android and Linux

Aakash 4 specifications are finally out, and the Indian government has officially made a statement on how it plans to bring out the next generation of the Aakash tablet series. Aakash I was a success in the Indian tablet market but the follow-ups, Aakash II and III, made headlines for all the wrong reasons.



While it's pretty certain that the upcoming tablet will be an improvement in terms of hardware, the biggest news is that it will be based on a dual-boot platform, i.e., Android and Linux (through a microSD card). The tablet computers, produced by MHRD, were conceptualised as a very low cost device with 17.78-cm (7-inch) touchscreen displays based on Android.

A new logo for Motorola Mobility!

To all those waiting to hear about Motorola Mobility ever since it was acquired by Google, the most interesting news is the new brand logo.

Unlike the previous thick and italic font style, the new logo has a thinner and softer look. The core M remains, but it now has more colours added to it. And it comes with 'a Google company' tagline.

The previous change to the logo came when it split from Motorola Solutions. Back then, the company tweaked the M from monochrome to a bright red colour.